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UAE Presidential Court

## UAE SIGNS STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIPS WITH THREE COUNTRIES

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan met Italian Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni and Albanian Prime Minister Edi Rama in Abu Dhabi yesterday as the three nations signed a tripartite partnership framework to enhance cooperation in renewable energy. The UAE also signed an agreement with Uzbekistan, formalising the strategic partnership between the two nations. **SEE ALSO P4**

## 9-hour film highlights perils of unlimited screen time for kids

Documentary a wake-up call for society to address phone addiction

**DUBAI**  
**BY SHARMILA DHAL**  
UAE Editor

The buzz around the growing silence of mobile phones in schools across the world is getting louder. Besides state initiatives like Australia's ban on smartphones in public schools, individual and community campaigns are also gaining momentum as unchecked, unlimited screen

time has been found to impact children negatively, with serious repercussions to their physical, mental and emotional well-being.

Yesterday, glimpses of a powerful film, believed to have the longest running time – nine hours – in the region's history, sought to mirror the time kids spend daily on their smartphones at a private screening in Dubai. The event took the campaign to “end the scroll” to a new level, prompting a public debate on the issue. Backed by evidence and proffering solutions, it hoped that families would sit up, take stock and help children – and themselves – manage screen time.

As Thomas Young, creative director behind the film, told *Gulf News*: “Millions of children spend their days scrolling their lives away on smartphones. The film serves as a wake-up call for parents, educators and the community, urging them to take action before it's too late.”

Dr Alison Burrows, an expert on screen time, professor and parent coach, said, “Children are more exposed to screens and online platforms than ever before, which can lead to serious negative consequences if not managed properly by schools, parents and the wider community.”

**SEE ALSO P2**

## Faster immigration clearance at 7 more Indian airports from today

Travellers must register online to benefit from scheme

**NEW DELHI**

A fast-track immigration process for pre-verified Indian nationals and Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) cardholders will be rolled out at Mumbai, Chennai, Kolkata, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Kochi and Ahmedabad airports today.

Union Home Minister Amit

Shah will launch the ‘Fast Track Immigration’ Trusted Traveller Programme’ (FTI-TTP) from Ahmedabad.

**How to enrol**

The FTI-TTP has been implemented through an online portal: <https://ftittp.mha.gov.in>. To enrol in this programme, applicants need to complete online registration by filling in their details and uploading the required documents on the portal.

The biometric data of the ap-

plicants will be captured either at the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO) or while passing through the airport. Registered travellers will need to scan their boarding pass at the e-gate, followed by scanning their passport.

At both the arrival and departure points, the passenger's biometrics will be authenticated at the e-gates. Once this authentication is successful, the e-gate will automatically open, and immigration clearance will be deemed granted. —PTI

## Hamas, Israel agree on Gaza ceasefire

MORE THAN 1,000 PALESTINIAN PRISONERS TO BE RELEASED IN EXCHANGE FOR 33 ISRAELI HOSTAGES

**DOHA**

Israel and Hamas agreed yesterday to a deal for a ceasefire and the release of hostages being held in Gaza following separate meetings with Qatar's prime minister. A US official also confirmed the deal.

Pressure to put an end to the fighting had ratcheted up in recent days, as mediators Qatar, Egypt and the United States intensified efforts to cement an agreement.

A source close to the talks said Qatari Prime Minister Shaiikh Mohammad Bin Abdulrahman Bin Jassim Al Thani was “meeting Hamas negotiators in his office for (a) final push” to seal the deal.

A source briefed on the talks later told AFP a “Gaza ceasefire and hostage release deal (was) reached following (the) Qatari PM's meeting with Hamas negotiators and separately Israeli negotiators in his office”.

The announcement comes after months of failed bids to end the deadliest war in Gaza's history, and days ahead of the inauguration of US president-elect Donald Trump, who immediately hailed the deal before it was officially announced by the White House.

“We have a deal for the hostages in the Middle East. They

### GAZANS CELEBRATE TRUCE DEAL



People celebrate along a street in Khan Younis in the southern Gaza Strip.

**1** The deal would last 42 days and involve a temporary halt to military operations on both sides; cessation of flyovers by Israeli warplanes

**2** Coordination was “underway” to reopen the Rafah crossing on Gaza's border with Egypt “to allow the entry of international aid to improve conditions”

**47,707**  
Palestinians killed in Gaza war that has lasted 15 months

will be released shortly. Thank you!” Trump said on his Truth Social network.

### Three phases

Egypt's state-linked Al Qahera news outlet reported that the framework agreement comprised three interconnected phases.

The first, it said, would last 42 days and involve a temporary halt to military operations on both sides, the withdrawal of Israeli forces away from population centres and towards Gaza's borders, and the temporary cessation of flyovers by Israeli warplanes and reconnaissance aircraft for 10 hours each day.

Al-Qahera cited an Egyptian

security source as saying coordination was “underway” to reopen the Rafah crossing on Gaza's border with Egypt “to allow the entry of international aid to improve conditions”.

State-owned Al Ahram newspaper also reported that talks were underway to open the crossing.

Israeli government spokesman David Mencer had previously said the first phase of a deal would see 33 Israeli hostages freed, while two Palestinian sources close to Hamas told AFP that Israel would release about 1,000 Palestinian prisoners in exchange.

—AFP

**SEE ALSO P9**



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